

HYPOVOLEMIC SHOCK

1. Case definition

Hypovolemic shock occurs when the patient's blood circulation has difficulty being maintained due to fluid loss: bleeding, acute or chronic dehydration, burns.

* **Think of hypovolemic shock in case of :**

- external or internal bleeding
- severe burns
- peritonitis
- diarrhea and vomiting, dehydration
- intestinal obstruction
- acute allergic reaction

* **Symptoms :**

- Pulse >100/min (patient at rest)
- Thready pulse (= rapid pulse difficult to palpate)
- BP drops gradually or $BP_{max} < 9$ cmHg
- Non-specific symptoms: patient becomes confused, nervous, agitated, thirsty.

2. Case management

a) Observation :

In the event of a referral, the details of the observation form should be noted on the referral form, so that the district doctor can better estimate the patient's state of health.

Signs to follow:

- * Pulse, BP and signs of consciousness: every 15 minutes if bleeding cannot be stopped or in case of severe shock; otherwise, every 30 minutes to an hour.
- * Levels of consciousness :
 - Level 1: normal consciousness
 - Level 2: confused, but responds to questions
 - Level 3: responds with difficulty, follows orders
 - Level 4: responds to stimuli
 - Level 5: no longer reacts to pain
- * T° : patient arrival, then every three hours if there is a risk infection, or if the first reading was > 38.5°C.

OBSERVATION FOR A PATIENT IN HYPOVOLEMIC SHOCK

Date and time									
Pulse									
TA									
Level of consciousness									
T°									
Bleeding (+, ++, +++)									

b) Treatment

- * Treat the cause if possible (see respective TPS)
- * **Symptomatic treatment: Ringer's infusion - if not available 0.9% NaCl infusion.**

- 1 liter immediately if there is a real risk shock
- according BP: each unit drop (e.g. from 11 to 10 cmHg) is worth 1 liter
- $TA_{min} < 6$ cmHg: Ringer infusion until $TA_{min} = 8$ cmHg
- **maintain the infusion during transport to district hospital.**

Remarks : Each unit of Ringer or NaCl given must be shown on the reference sheet.

For children: see FT Rehydration for Ringer's and ORS doses.